RR-T-646b
March 14, 1966
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. RR-T-646a
June 4, 1956

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TRAYS, PROCESSING, PHOTOGRAPHIC

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers trays for processing photographic sheet film, plates and paper.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types and sizes.* Trays furnished under this specification shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified (see 6.2).

Types:

I—Corrosion-resistant metal.
II—Porcelain enamel metal.
III—Hard rubber.
IV—Plastic.
V—Glass fiber reinforced polyester.

Sizes:

1—To accommodate 8- by 10-inch print size.
2—To acommodate 11- by 14-inch print size.
3—To accommodate 16- by 20-inch print size.
4—To accommodate 20- by 24-inch print size.
5—To accommodate 24- by 30-inch print size.
6—To accommodate 40- by 40-inch print size.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

O-A-76—Acetic Acid, Glacial, Technical.
QQ-S-766—Steel Plates, Sheets, and Strip—Corrosion Resisting.
PPP-B-566—Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665—Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676—Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406—Plastics: Methods of Testing.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Specifications:

MIL-P-116—Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-D-4824—Developer, Photographic, High Contrast, Armed Forces Developer No. 1.
MIL-E-5272—Environmental Testing, Aeronautical and Associated Equipment, General Specification for.
MIL-P-8013—Plastic Materials, Polyester Resin, Glass Fiber Base, Low Pressure Laminated.
MIL-W-8611—Welding, Metal Arc and Gas, Steels, and Corrosion and Heat Resistant Alloys, Process for.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 **Other publication.** The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Standards Association (ASA) Standard:

PH4.3—Photographic Trays.

(Copies may be obtained from the American Standards Association, Inc., 10 E. 40th St., New York, N. Y., 10016.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Inertness.** Each type of tray shall be made of material which is substantially inert to and which will not cause any adverse affect on the photographic chemical solutions that will be contained. The trays shall be suitable for use with the following kinds of photographic solutions: acid short stop bath, acid fixing bath, acid silver nitrate, cyanides, alkaline developers, and alcohol.

3.2 **Type I.** The type I trays shall be made of corrosion resistant steel conforming to QQ-S-766, class 316.

3.2.1 *Finish.* The type I trays shall have a finish at least equal to No. 4 polish on the inside and No. 2 finish on the outside conforming to QQ-S-766.

3.3 **Type II.**

3.3.1 *Metal.* The base metal shall be an enameling grade of sheet iron or steel, of the low metalloid and copper content, especially manufactured and processed for the production of porcelain enameled units. The surface of the base shall be thoroughly cleaned of grease and scale before application of the enamel.

3.3.2 *Enamel.* The porcelain enamel coating shall consist of a cobalt-bearing ground coat plus one or more acid resisting cover coats as required. The porcelain enamel coating shall be applied to the metal and fused at, or above, a red heat. The ground coat shall be fired prior to the application of the cover coat.

3.3.3 *Color.* The inside and outside of the trays shall be white. The bead may be coated with an enamel of different color from the body.

3.3.4 *Thickness of coating.* The coating shall be commercially uniform in thickness over the entire area of the tray. The average thickness of the coating, when measured as specified in section 4, shall be 0.018 inch with a tolerance of 0.006 inch. The thickness of any of the spots measured shall be not less than 0.012 inch.

3.3.5 *Chemical resistance.* The trays shall pass the blurring highlight test and the wet rubbing test after treatment as specified in section 4.

3.3.6 *Finish.* The trays shall be completely covered with porcelain enamel. The finish shall be glossy and free from pits, blisters, ridges, and other defects which may impair its serviceability.

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3.4 **Type III.**

3.4.1 *Material.* The type III trays shall be molded of hard rubber meeting the requirements of this specification.

3.4.2 *Water absorbtion.* The weight of the tray shall increase not more than 0.5 percent when tested for water absorbtion as specified in section 4.

3.4.3 *Alcoholic extract.* The alcoholic extract of the hard rubber shall not exceed 0.002 gram per square centimeter when immersed in boiling alcohol for 24 hours as specified in section 4.

3.4.4 *Tensile strength.* The ultimate strength of the hard rubber shall be not less than 4,500 pounds per square inch (p.s.i.) for trays 11 by 14 inches and over, and 3,000 p.s.i. for trays under 11 by 14 inches, when tested as specified in method 1011 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406.

3.4.5 *Finish.* All surfaces shall be free from pits, blisters, ridges, and other defects which may impair its serviceability.

3.5 **Type IV.**

3.5.1 *Material.* The plastic trays shall be molded of a moderate impact strength phenolic or other plastic molding compound meeting the requirements of this specification.

3.5.2 *Water absorbtion.* The weight of the tray shall increase not more than 0.5 percent when tested for water absorbtion as specified in section 4.

3.5.3 *Impact strength.* The impact strength of specimens cut from plastic trays shall be not less than 0.80 foot-pounds per inch of notch when tested as specified in method 1071 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406.

3.5.4 *Tensile strength.* The ultimate strength of specimens cut from plastic trays shall be not less than 5,500 p.s.i. when tested as specified in method 1011 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406.

3.5.5 *Finish.* The surfaces of the plastic shall not be painted or coated in any way. The surfaces shall be smooth and free from pits, blisters, ridges, and other defects which may impair its serviceability.

3.6 **Type V.**

3.6.1 *Material.* The type V trays shall be molded of glass fiber reinforced with polyester resin conforming to MIL-P-8013, type I.

3.6.2 *Water absorbtion.* The weight of the tray shall increase not more than 0.5 percent when tested for water absorbtion as specified in section 4.

3.6.3 *Finish.* All surfaces shall be smooth and free from pits, blisters, ridges, and other defects which may impair its serviceability.

3.7 **Design.** The trays shall be designed essentially in accordance with figure 1 and table I herein and ASA Standard PH4.3. Slight variations made necessary by the use of different type materials will be permitted.

3.7.1 *Mechanical design.* The detailed mechanical design of the trays shall be accomplished by the manufacturer subject to the requirements of this specification. Requirements are detailed herein only to the extent considered necessary to insure the performance and permanence in use of the desired characteristics.

3.7.2 *Forming.* Except as specified under "welding", types I and II trays shall be drawn to shape from one piece of sheet metal.

3.7.3 *Welding.* Welded construction will be permitted only on types I and II trays of sizes 20 by 24 inches or larger and only when specifically called for in the procurement document (see 6.2). All joints in type I trays shall be welded by the electric arc, inert gas shielded method conforming to the requirements of MIL-W-8611. The use of solder of any kind on type I trays is specifically prohibited and corner welds shall

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be avoided. Welds shall be ground, polished, and passivated in a manner to restore the finish and retain the corrosion characteristics of the original metal. Welds in type II trays shall be free from pits, cracks, and included slag. Welds in type II trays shall be ground smooth and shall be leak proof before coating.

3.7.4 *Sturdiness.* The trays shall have structural strength to withstand long periods of continuous use and repeated rough handling.

3.7.5 *Reinforcing ribs.* Tray bottoms shall be flat and free from buckling or warping. Reinforcing ribs may be used on all trays for added strength and to insure flatness of bottoms. Ribs, if used, shall be substantially in accordance with figure 1.

3.7.6 *Exposure to extreme temperatures.* The trays shall not suffer any permanent distortion or damage as a result of exposure to any temperature from minus 65°F. to plus 160°F. when tested as specified in section 4.

3.8 **Workmanship.** Trays shall be of highest quality workmanship comparable to best commercial practice for each designated type of tray.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 **Sampling.** Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105.

4.3 **Inspection lot.** For the purpose of sampling, a lot shall consist of all the trays of the same type offered for delivery at one time.

4.4 **Classification of inspections.** Inspections shall be classified as follows:

(a) In-process inspection.
(b) Visual inspection.
(c) End item inspection.

4.5 **In-process inspection.** During the fabrication of types I and II trays, verify that the metal is the correct material. Verify that the base metal for type II trays has been properly cleaned before application of the enamel as required in section 3.

TABLE I. *Dimensions for trays*

Print size	Measurement: Inches Dimensions: Minimum				Radii: Inches—minimum		
	A	B	C	D(a)	Corner R_1	Bottom R_2	Lip R_3 measured normal maximum
8 by 10	9.00	11.00	2.00	24	0.25	0.13	0.30
11 by 14	12.00	15.00	2.50	22	.50	.25	.25
16 by 20	17.00	21.00	2.75	20	.50	.25	.25
20 by 24	21.00	25.00	3.25	20	.50	.25	.25(c)
24 by 30	25.00	31.00	4.00(b)	20	.50	.25	.25(c)
40 by 40	41.00	41.00	4.00(b)	20	.50	.25	.25(c)

(a) Minimum U. S. Standard Gage of Metal for types I and II trays.
(b) When specified this dimension may be 6.00 inches (see 6.2).
(c) No lip required.

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4.5.1 *Welding.* During the fabrication of welded types I and II trays verify that the metal has been properly prepared and welding performed as required in section 3. Verify that welds in type I trays are properly made, ground smooth, and passivated to retain the corrosion resistant properties of the parent metal as required in section 3.

4.5.2 *Coating.* During the fabrication of type II trays verify that the enamel coating has been fused at red heat as required in section 3.

4.6 **Visual inspection.** Types I, II, III, IV, and V trays shall be examined visually and with gages for dimensions, configuration, sturdiness, finish, and workmanship as required in section 3. The inspection level, for determining sample size, shall be level I and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0. The sample unit shall be one tray.

4.7 **End item inspection.** Trays shall be tested as specified in table II. The inspection level, for determining sample size, shall be S-2 and AQL shall be 4.0. The sample unit shall be one tray.

4.8 **Test methods.**

4.8.1 *Chemical fog.* Prepare a developer conforming to the formula (D19) as given in MIL-D-4824. Place a specimen cut from the tray under test in a glass bottle, fill with developer and stopper tightly. The size of the container shall be such that not more than four milliliters of developer per square centimeter of sample surface is needed to fill the container. For a control, fill a like container with the developer and stopper tightly. Store the two containers at room temperature (70° ± 5°F.) for 168 hours. Remove the sample and use the solution to develop two sheets of unexposed film in total darkness. Process the film according to the film manufacturer's instructions and when dry measure the density. Repeat the procedure using the developer from the control and two sheets of film from the same box. The average of the fog densities of the two sample films shall not exceed the average fog densities of the two control films by more than 0.02. The requirements covering chemical fogging shall be satisfied by the acceptance of a certificate of compliance from the contractor.

4.8.2 *Material.* The requirements covering material shall be satisfied by the acceptance of a certificate of compliance from the contractor.

4.8.3 *Thickness of enamel coating.* The thickness of the enamel coating shall be measured with a magnetic thickness gage calibrated to 0.001 inch, or by any other means acceptable to the procuring agency. Measurements shall be made at two points near the center of the inside bottom and two points near the center of the outside bottom. The two measurements shall be averaged to determine the representative thickness of the enamel on each side. The tray fails the test when the thickness on

TABLE II.

Type I	Requirement	3.3.2					
	Test	4.8.2					
Type II	Requirement	3.3.1	3.3.2	3.3.4	3.3.5	3.7.6	
	Test	4.8.2	4.8.2	4.8.3	4.8.4	4.8.8	
Type III	Requirement	3.1	3.4.1	3.4.2	3.4.3	3.4.4	3.7.6
	Test	4.8.1	4.8.2	4.8.5	4.8.6	4.8.7	4.8.8
Type IV	Requirement	3.1	3.5.1	3.5.2	3.5.3	3.5.4	3.7.6
	Test	4.8.1	4.8.2	4.8.5	4.8.7	4.8.7	4.8.8
Type V	Requirement	3.1	3.6.1	3.6.3	3.7.6		
	Test	4.8.1	4.8.2	4.8.5	4.8.8		

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either side fails to meet the requirements of section 3.

4.8.4 *Chemical resistance.* The tray shall be tilted at such an angle that when liquid is poured in until the low end is full, the bottom shall be approximately two-thirds covered. The first liquid to be used shall be a solution of 7.7 grams of anhydrous sodium hydroxide in one gallon of ordinary soft or medium-hard tap water. The second solution shall be 58 ± 5 percent acetic acid in accordance with O-A-76. Each solution shall be permitted to remain undisturbed in the tray for at least 24 hours. At the end of each period indicated, the solution shall be poured from the tray, rinsed with tap water, gently wiped dry, and the "blurring highlight test" and the "wet rubbing test" accomplished.

4.8.4.1 *Blurring highlight test.* In a well lighted location, hold the tray so that the image of a small light source, such as a frosted lamp bulb, is observed as a highlight on the untreated area adjacent to the treated area, the line of vision being within 45° of perpendicular to the surface. Focus eyes on the image of the light source not on the surface of the specimen. Then shift the tray just sufficiently to bring the image into the treated area, observing it as it passes across the boundary line. When viewed as specified above, the tray passes the test if the highlight is not blurred. Slight iridescence or faint discoloration without loss of gloss shall not constitute a basis for rejection. Any mechanical imperfection, such as chipping, flaking, or cracking caused by the test solution shall be cause for rejection.

4.8.4.2 *Wet rubbing test.* Make several marks with a No. 1 lead pencil under firm pressure, extending across the treated and untreated areas. Rub the marks lightly with a cloth which has previously been dipped into water and twisted tightly to eliminate excess water. No soap, abrasive, or similar cleaning material shall be used. If the marks over the treated area are definitely more difficult to remove than those over the untreated area, the tray fails the test.

4.8.5 *Water absorbtion.* The test for water absorbtion shall be performed in conformance with procedure A, method 7031 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406, except that the tray shall be filled with water instead of immersed and the duration of the test shall be 48 hours.

4.8.6 *Alcoholic extract.* Samples for the alcoholic extract test shall have surface area of not less than 200 square centimeters, which shall consist, insofar as practicable, of the original surface of the article under test. The alcohol used for this test shall be ethanol, containing not more than five percent of water and not more than ten percent of methanol. The samples shall be immersed in boiling alcohol for 24 hours in such a way that the alcohol has free access to all surfaces. At least one milliliter of alcohol shall be used for each square centimeter of surface. At the conclusion of the extraction period, the alcoholic solution shall be evaporated to dryness in a tared vessel heated for one hour at 105° ± 5°C., cooled in a desiccator, and weighed. A blank determination shall be run at the same time and correction made for the residue from the alcohol alone. The requirements covering alcoholic extraction shall be satisfied by the acceptance of a certificate of compliance from the contractor.

4.8.7 *Strength tests.* The requirements covering tensile strength and impact shall be satisfied by the acceptance of a certificate of compliance from the contractor.

4.8.8 *Exposure to extreme temperatures.* The test shall conform to the high temperature tests, procedure I, and the low temperature tests, procedure I, or MIL-E-5272, with the exception that the trays shall be returned to room condition before inspection. The requirements covering exposure to extreme temperatures shall be satisfied by the acceptance of a certificate of compliance from the contractor.

4.9 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made

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to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements in section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. *Classification of preparation for delivery defects*

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling.
Contents (interior container)	Number per container is more or less than required. Net weight exceeds requirements.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement, the definitions and application of levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.)

5.1 **Packaging.** Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.* The trays shall be packaged in accordance with method IC-2 of MIL-P-116 in quantities as specified in table IV.

5.1.2 *Level B.* The trays shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676 in quantities as specified in table IV.

5.1.3 *Level C.* The trays shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 **Packing.** Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.* Unit packages of trays of like description in quantities as specified shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Unit packages of trays of like description in quantities as specified shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.* The trays shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 **Marking.**

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military activities.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

TABLE IV. *Packaging quantities*

Types	Size	Unit package quantities
I	All	1
II		
III	8 by 10	
IV	11 by 14	3
V		
III	16 by 20	
IV	20 by 24	
V	24 by 30	1
	40 by 40	

6. NOTES

6.1 **Intended use.** The trays specified in this document are intended to be used for

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processing photographic films, plates, and paper.

6.2 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Type of tray. (See 1.2.1.)
(*c*) Size of tray. (See 1.2.2.)
(*d*) Six inch deep trays, if required. (See table I.)
(*e*) Welded trays, if required. (See 3.7.3.)
(*f*) Responsibility for inspection. (See 4.1.)
(*g*) Level of packaging and packing required. (See 5.1 and 5.2.)

CUSTODIANS:

Army—EL
Navy—WP
Air Force—67

Review activities:

Army—ERDL
Navy—WP
Air Force—

User activities:

Army—EL
Navy—MC
Air Force—

Preparing activity:

Navy—WP

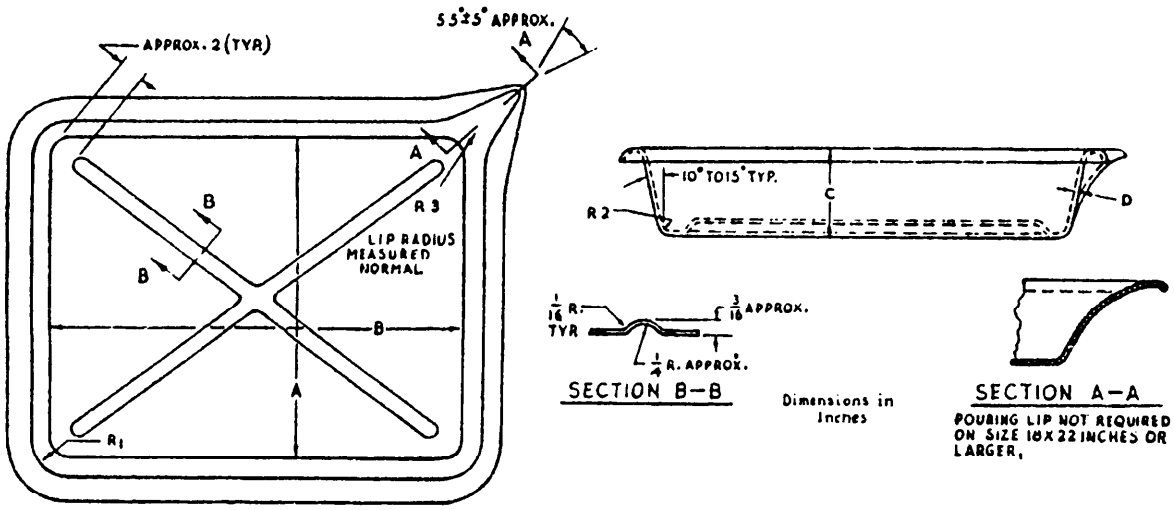


FIGURE 1. Trays, photographic

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